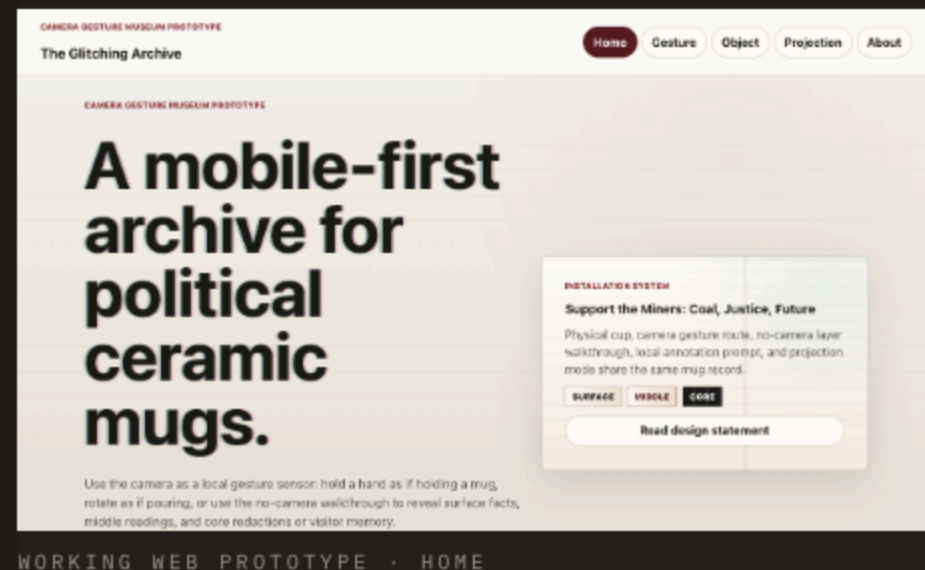


MOBILE-FIRST · GESTURE-BASED ARCHIVE

The Glitching Archive: Warmth & Echoes

A mobile-first, gesture-based archive for political ceramic mugs at V&A East Storehouse.

POLITICAL CERAMIC MUGS AS VESSELS OF PUBLIC MEMORY



TITLE

THREE QUESTIONS

How might a stored object become emotionally accessible?

HMW 01

Frame

How do museum storage, catalogue language, and label systems shape what a political mug is allowed to mean?

BRIEF ALIGNMENT · OBJECT GROUP, FRAMING ANALYSIS, DIGITAL DISPLAY, ETHICS

HMW 02

Layer

How can visible facts, speculative readings, and withheld memories sit together without becoming false certainty?

HMW 03

Invite

How can visitors question and contribute to object narratives without turning sensitive histories into a vote?

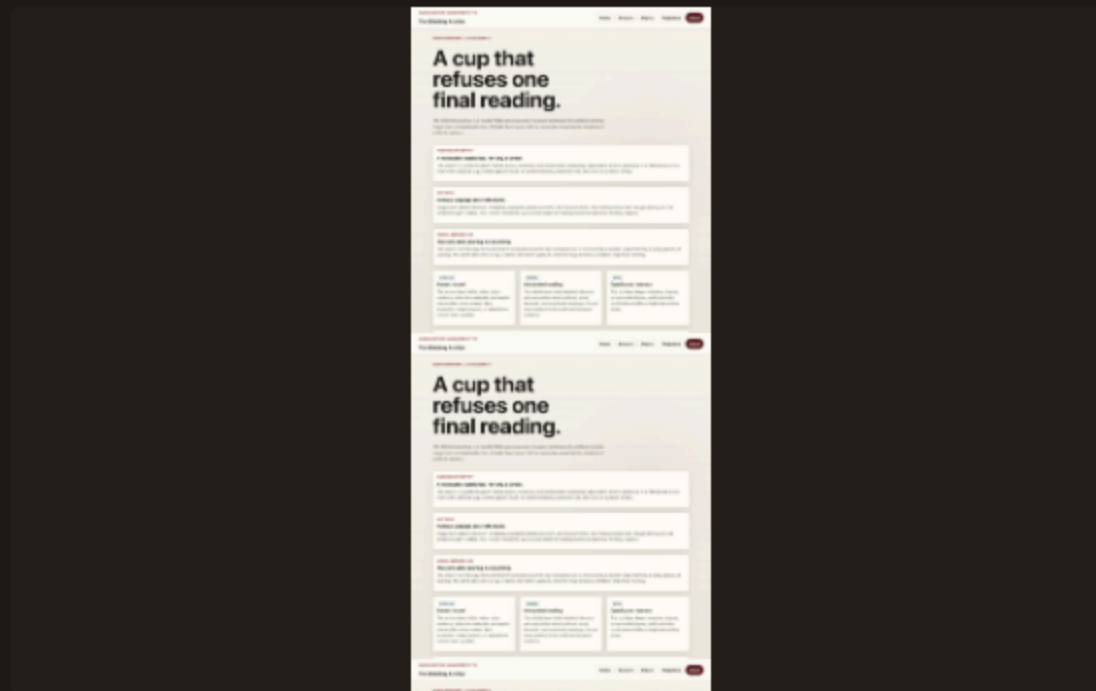
HMW

PRIMARY AUDIENCE · USE CONTEXT

Open storage still needs interpretive access.

Primary audience: young V&A East Storehouse visitors and local East London visitors who encounter the mugs physically but do not usually search catalogue records.

V&A EAST STOREHOUSE · MOBILE COMPANION · SHARED PROJECTION WALL



Three mugs map public politics into domestic handling.



C.174-1991 · 0145585

Support the Miners

Mug, 1984. Maker: Commemorative Pottery. Earthenware, glazed. Given by Oliver Watson. Selected for labour conflict, solidarity, and strike memory.



C.167-1991 · 0172597

Labour Mug

Mug, designed ca.1989 / made ca.1990. Maker unknown. Earthenware with printed decoration and glaze. Given by the Labour Party.



C.106-1991 · 0171653

Peoples March for Jobs

Mug, 1981. Maker unknown. Earthenware. Given by Ray Hickman and Louise Purbrick. Selected for unemployment, protest route, and named marcher memory.

V&A RECORD EXTRACT

Catalogue records preserve facts, but not lived use.

MUSEUM RECORD SHOWS

Date / material

1981-1990, earthenware,
glaze, printed decoration.

Maker / credit

Unknown, Commemorative
Pottery, Labour Party gift,
private donors.

Inscription

Slogans, route text, named
marcher, strike dates, party
mark.

V&A RECORDS: 0145585, 0172597, 0171653

INTERFACE CRITIQUE

Interface asks

WHO USED IT? WHERE WAS IT KEPT? WHAT CONFLICT DOES IT
INDEX? WHICH MEMORIES ARE MISSING, DISPUTED, OR
WITHHELD?

Framing shift

FROM MATERIAL CLASSIFICATION TO EVIDENCE-MARKED PUBLIC
MEMORY.

FRAMING

FROM CONCEPT TO RESEARCH-BACKED OUTCOME

Evidence is organised before speculation begins.

MUSEUM RECORDS

3 V&A APIs

Object metadata, inscriptions, donor credit, image rights, location at Storehouse display level 2.

FIELDWORK

Display Study

On-site storage display observation and user-supplied object photographs; glass, distance, and labels shape access.

ABSENCES REMAIN VISIBLE: ORAL TESTIMONY AND COMMUNITY MEMORY REQUIRE CONSENT AND MODERATION

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

1981-1984

People's March for Jobs, miners' strike memory, Labour red rose and party identity.

PROTOTYPE EVIDENCE

Web Route

Gesture route, slider fallback, projection wall, LocalStorage contribution, right-to-opacity text.

RESEARCH

CUP AS VESSEL

The cup holds more than liquid.

PHYSICAL VOLUME

Tea, ceramic surface, handle, printed slogans, maker, date, damage, catalogue metadata.

EMOTIONAL VOLUME

Political attachment, domestic routine, labour memory, family disagreement, withheld harm, local testimony.

SURFACE / MIDDLE / CORE

The layers show evidence status, not hidden truth.

SUPPORT THE MINERS • C.174-1991

Surface

Fact

1984 earthenware mug; inscription links coal, future, justice, and strike dates.

Middle

Inference

Domestic political display; solidarity object; kitchen as political space.

Core

Consent

Local testimony, withheld names, redacted memory, or contested family story.



EACH FRAGMENT IS LABELLED: FACT, INFERENCE, SPECULATION, VISITOR MEMORY, REDACTED, NEEDS CONSENT

LAYERS

The prototype turns browsing into a bodily gesture.

VISITOR FLOW

01

Scan

Enter the mobile companion from a label, QR, or display prompt.

02

Choose

Select a mug and inspect verified object metadata.

03

Pour

Tilt phone, rotate hand, permit camera, or use slider fallback.

04

Read

Follow fact, inference, redaction, and contribution labels.

05

Contribute

Submit a labelled question, memory, dispute, or counter-reading.

TILT / ROTATION / CAMERA / SLIDER

Pour value controls the archive layer.

SYSTEM CHAIN

Input

Phone tilt, hand rotation, optional camera permission, slider fallback.

Mapping

Tilt angle becomes pour value.

Layer

Surface 0-33%, Middle 34-66%, Core 67-100%.

Output

Object tilt, fragment reveal, evidence label, redaction state.

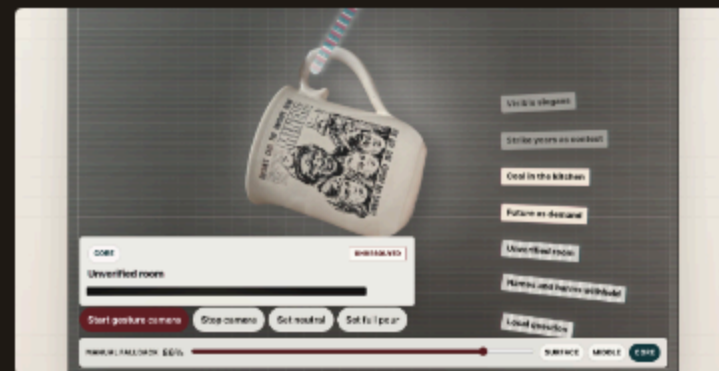
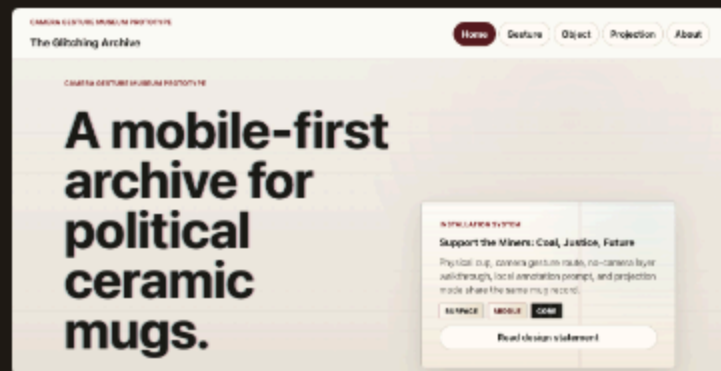
No video is recorded or uploaded. The interaction can run without camera permission through tilt or slider fallback.

PRIVACY AND ACCESS ARE BUILT INTO THE INTERACTION MODEL



SYSTEM

Working screens demonstrate the archive logic.



The design outcome includes a phone route, no-camera route, layer logic, local contribution loop, and projection mode.

SUPPORT SYSTEM, NOT HISTORIAN

AI can organise uncertainty; it cannot decide truth.

AI can

GENERATE VISITOR
PROMPTS • COMPARE
FRAGMENTS • SUGGEST
UNCERTAINTY LABELS •

AI cannot

INVENT ORAL TESTIMONY
• DECIDE TRUTH •
REMOVE REDACTION •
PUBLISH VISITOR

REQUIRED LABELS • AI-ASSISTED SPECULATION / CATALOGUE FACT / VISITOR MEMORY / REDACTED / NEEDS CONSENT



AI

Visitor memory does not go straight onto the wall.

MODERATION PIPELINE

01

Submit

Visitor adds memory, dispute, question, or counter-reading.

02

Label

Response is automatically marked as visitor contribution.

03

Pending

Sensitive histories stay off-wall while awaiting review.

04

Review

Curator or community moderator contextualises the response.

05

Project / Withhold

Public response appears with context or remains withheld.

PRIVACY

No Upload

No visitor video is recorded or uploaded.

ACCESS

Fallback

Slider and no-camera route preserve access.

CONSENT

Withhold

Some material stays redacted until evidence and

CONTRIBUTION IS LABELLED, PENDING, REVIEWED, THEN PROJECTED OR WITHHELD

ETHICS

STORAGE DISPLAY → MOBILE POUR → COLLECTIVE WALL

A single museum encounter moves from object to public response.

Storage display

VISITOR ENCOUNTERS POLITICAL MUGS
PHYSICALLY.



Phone pour gesture

and local visitor memory.

WHS STORY	WHS STORY	WHS STORY
Support the Miners: Coal, Justice, Future Printed strike years: 1972, 1974, 1984 REDACTED Unverified room Redaction remains visible as an archive state.	Labour Red Rose: Party Name, Domestic Signal Possibly 1986, pending object-match verification REDACTED Possession is not proof Redaction remains visible as an archive state.	People's March for Jobs: Route Held in a Cup May 1981, pending object-match verification REDACTED Missing shops Redaction remains visible as an archive state.
Names and names withheld REDACTED Redaction remains visible as an archive state.	What the logo cannot hold REDACTED Redaction remains visible as an archive state.	Oral histories withheld REDACTED Redaction remains visible as an archive state.
VISITOR CONTRIBUTION Local question Did this image feel like solidarity.	VISITOR CONTRIBUTION Counter-reading prompt	VISITOR CONTRIBUTION Place prompt

RETRO ARCHIVE · STATIC · DOCUMENTARY FRAGMENT

Glitch marks uncertainty, not decoration.

VISUAL / AUDITORY RULES

Archive

Warm paper, deep ink,
catalogue metadata.

Glitch

Only for absence, redaction,
speculation.

Sound

Layer captions / generated
fallback, not finished audio
claim.

PRECEDENTS + READINGS

DESIGN PRECEDENT

Karim Ben Khelifa, *The Enemy* — interactive journalism and spatial empathy.

DESIGN PRECEDENT

Manual of Errors — uncertainty as interface condition.

CRITICAL FABULATION

Saidiya Hartman, "Venus in Two Acts," *Small Axe* 12(2), 2008.

DIGITAL HERITAGE

Ross Parry, *Recoding the Museum: Digital Heritage and the Technologies of Change*,
Routledge, 2007.

NO DRAFT CITATION NOTES REMAIN IN THE SUBMISSION DECK

REFERENCES

THESIS

The cup does not reveal one stable truth.

The Glitching Archive uses political ceramic mugs from V&A East Storehouse as everyday vessels of public memory. Through a mobile-first pouring interaction, visitors move between catalogue facts, speculative interpretation, redacted histories, and local contribution. The project does not claim to uncover a single hidden answer. Instead, it makes the archive's cracks, absences, and evidence boundaries visible, turning physical access into emotional and critical access.

AUDIENCE YOUNG STOREHOUSE + EAST LONDON VISITORS · AI LABELLED SUPPORT SYSTEM · ETHICS CONSENT BEFORE PROJECTION

CONTEXT · AUDIENCE · AI · ETHICS · PROTOTYPE · REFERENCES

END